XUEJIAN (RON) WANG

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. Agricultural Economics, Purdue University — expected May 2027

Advisor: Joseph Balagtas

M.Sc. Applied Economics, University of Idaho — August 2023

M.A. International Trade, Zhejiang University of Finance & Economics — July 2021

B.A. Economics, Yunnan University — July 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agricultural Economics; Consumer Demand; Food, Nutrition, and Health Policy; Agribusiness; Applied Industrial Organization

JOB MARKET PAPER

- **"How GLP-1 Medications Are Changing the Caloric and Nutritional Content of Household Grocery Purchases"** (with Joseph Balagtas)

  We provide evidence on how adoption of GLP-1 medications changes the calories and key nutrients in household grocery purchases. We merge transaction-level grocery data for a large panel of U.S. households with product-level nutrient contents. We use staggered difference-in-differences event studies on a matched panel of adopter and never-adopter households. Calories purchased and grocery spending both fall in the adoption half-year. After that, the calorie effect is no longer distinguishable from zero. The calorie cuts are largest for adopters of weight-loss-indicated medications. Most nutrients, including protein and fiber, decline with calories at initiation, while sugar and added sugar do not fall significantly. The most persistent cuts occur in meat and beans, a main source of protein. These results point to a role for dietary guidance alongside the medication, especially for protein. Latest draft: xuejian-wang-ron.github.io/assets/pdf/Wang_JMP.pdf

PUBLICATIONS

- Katare, B., **Wang, X.**, Zhao, S., Yenerall, J. (2025). "Novel Approaches to Analyze Consumer Behavior and Policies to Promote Sustainable Consumption", *Agricultural Economics*, 56: 512–525. doi.org/10.1111/agec.70027
- Du, X., **Wang, X.** and Hatzenbuehler, P. (2022). "Digital Technology in Agriculture: A Review of Issues, Applications, and Methodologies", *China Agricultural Economic Review*, Vol. 15 No. 1, pp. 95–108. doi.org/10.1108/CAER-01-2022-0009

WORKING PAPERS

- **Wang, X.**, Katare, B., Kundu, D. "Natural Disasters and Alcohol Sales: Evidence from Hurricanes." *SSRN Working Paper*. ssrn.com/abstract=6999318

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

- **Wang, X.**, Balagtas, J. "Fewer Groceries or Different Groceries? Demand Estimation for GLP-1-Adopting Households"
- **Wang, X.** "The Supply Response to Food Quality Concerns: An Application to Synthetic Dyes"
- Balagtas, J., Li, H., **Wang, X.**, Zhu, T. "Appearances Aren't Deceiving: Consumer Demand for Color versus Colorant in the Market for Synthetic Dyes"

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- "How GLP-1 Medications Are Changing the Caloric and Nutritional Content of Household Grocery Purchases" — ASSA Annual Meeting, Washington, DC (2027, scheduled); AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (2026)
- "The Supply Response to Food Quality Concerns: An Application to Synthetic Dyes" — AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (2026)
- "Natural Disasters and Alcohol Sales: Evidence from Hurricanes" — MEA Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL (2026); CES North America Annual Meeting, Ann Arbor, MI (2025); SEA Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL (2025)
- "Market, Environmental, and Policy Implications of Manure-based Fertilizer Development in Idaho: An Agent-Based Approach" — WAEA–CAES Annual Meeting, Whistler, BC, Canada (2023)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Guest Lecturer: AGEC 250: Economic Geography of World Food and Resources, Spring 2026
  Designed and taught a two-session introductory R module and its data assignment
- International Teaching Assistant (ITA) Certification, Purdue University, Fall 2025
  Semester-long training, including four practice lectures to undergraduates

RESEARCH FUNDING

2024	Jim and Neta Hicks Graduate Student Small Grant, Purdue University (Role: proposal author)	**$7,500**

AWARDS

2022	Edward J. and Maud R. Iddings Research Fellowship, University of Idaho	**$4,000**
2022	AAEA Travel Award	

REFEREE SERVICE

- Agricultural Economics

SERVICE

Purdue University	Social Chair, Treasurer, Graduate Student Mentor, Graduate Student Organization, Department of Agricultural Economics
University of Idaho	International Student Ambassador, International Programs Office

METHODS AND SKILLS

Methods	Applied microeconometrics: • Matched staggered difference-in-differences with heterogeneity-robust estimators • Event-study designs • Panel and reduced-form policy evaluation • Discrete-choice and demand-system demand estimation • Applied theory modeling of firm quality choice
Data	• Construction of large household- and product-level panels from consumer panel and retail scanner data (NielsenIQ, Kilts Center) • Harmonization and imputation of nutrition data across multiple product-level sources • Linking survey responses to household purchase records • Extraction of color information from product photographs
Tools	Python, R, Stata, HPC, GIS, LaTeX; reproducible, version-controlled data pipelines
Languages	Chinese (native); English (fluent)

REFERENCES

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